

# EXP: a practical learning experience, tested before scholars see it

Designing the leadership and entrepreneurship curriculum for Ugandan secondary schools and the mentors who teach it

**45%**

More likely to hit their life goals (education or entrepreneurial) for scholars who complete the program

**3 designers**

Team I manage, designing for scholars and for mentors

**10 years**

Gradual improvement in scholars' business model quality, linked to the practical approach

|             |                                                                                                   |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Role        | Product Strategist, managing a team of 3 learning designers                                       |
| Company     | Educate, whose flagship product, EXP, runs in Ugandan secondary schools                           |
| Scope       | Learning content for scholars, mentor training material and Training of Trainers (ToT) readiness  |
| Skills used | Backward design, curriculum development, quality control, team leadership, safeguarding in design |

## The challenge

EXP is delivered by mentors, so a curriculum is only as good as the way it lands with them. The challenge was twofold: keep the learning practical and connected to scholars' own lives, and make sure every curriculum change works before scholars ever learn it.

## What I did

- Lead a team of three designers who create learning content for secondary school scholars and training material for the mentors who train them, using the backward design framework: start from the outcome scholars need, then design the activities that get them there.
- Own Training of Trainers readiness ahead of each pre-term mentor training. It surfaces early feedback on curriculum changes so they can be tested before scholars learn them, the key quality control step in the design process.
- Keep the learning experiential: practical activities tied to scholars' own lives, plus group mentorship sessions twice a school term where students work through challenges together.
- Build safeguarding into the ToT sessions and the leadership and entrepreneurship curriculum, so scholars know the escalation pathways for any issue.

## The outcome

Scholars who complete the program are 45% more likely to hit their life goals, whether in education or entrepreneurship. The practical, experiential approach has also been linked to a gradual improvement in the quality of scholars' business models over the past decade.

## What I took from it

**Test with the people who will use it.** Across six years of leading learning design and curriculum teams, including at Andela and Moringa School, the pattern has held: changes tried first with trainers and learners arrive better, and quality control belongs inside the design process, not after it.